BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #66 · HEALING AND FAITH

# “If I had enough faith, God would heal me.”

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## Where it often comes from

Some teachers and friends say that healing depends on the size of our faith. When healing does not come, guilt and doubt pile on top of illness.

## What Scripture teaches

Jesus responded to faith that was weak: the father cried, “I do believe; help my unbelief!” and Jesus healed his son (Mark 9:24). Paul prayed three times about his thorn, and God said, “My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.” Timothy had frequent ailments, Epaphroditus was sick “nearly unto death,” and Paul left Trophimus “sick in Miletus.” Scripture treats illness as part of life, not as a faith failure. God can and does heal, and He does so by His wisdom, not by a formula.

> *“Immediately the boy’s father cried out, ‘I do believe; help my unbelief!’”* (Mark 9:24).

## Also see

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus” (2 Timothy 4:20).

> “He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow” (Philippians 2:27).

> “The LORD will sustain him on his bed of illness and restore him from his bed of sickness” (Psalm 41:3).

## Common self-statements

- My faith is too small.
- God is waiting for me to believe more.
- It is my fault I am not healed.
- Real faith always heals.
- I am blocking my own healing.
- I must try harder.

## Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing healing is either by faith or never.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will stay sick.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unhealed and concluding that my faith is weak.
- Labeling: Calling myself faithless.

## Challenging questions

- Who taught me that healing depends on faith?
- What did Jesus do with weak faith?
- What did Paul and others do when healing did not come?
- What does grace look like in my situation?

- How can I trust God without a guarantee?
- What care can I receive in the meantime?

## Truth summary

> My healing does not depend on the size of my faith. God hears even weak faith, and His grace is sufficient. I can ask for healing, receive medical care, and trust Him with the outcome.

## Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Faith
- Sickness
- Guilt/Shame
- Prayer, Answers to
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

## Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

## Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

*Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"*

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "If I had enough faith, God would heal me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"If I had enough faith, God would heal me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ Who taught me that healing depends on faith?
- ☐ What did Jesus do with weak faith?
- ☐ What did Paul and others do when healing did not come?
- ☐ What does grace look like in my situation?
- ☐ How can I trust God without a guarantee?
- ☐ What care can I receive in the meantime?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ Jesus hears "help my unbelief."
- ☐ His grace is sufficient.
- ☐ Paul's friends were sick too.
- ☐ Illness is not faith failure.
- ☐ I can ask for healing.
- ☐ I can trust God with the outcome.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Mark 9:24
  *"Immediately the boy's father cried out, 'I do believe; help my unbelief!'"*
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."*
- ☐ 2 Timothy 4:20
  *"Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus."*

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

# Practicing the Truth

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## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Trust, not formula: Each week, note one prayer and one act of trust.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  *For example, Mark 9:24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus hears even weak faith, and His grace is enough.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Faith" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] Read Mark 9:14–29. Notice Jesus' response to weak faith.
- [ ] Pray honestly. Ask for healing and grace.
- [ ] Receive care. Medical treatment and prayer support.
- [ ] Let go of blame. Talk with a pastor if guilt persists.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I had enough faith, God would heal me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Trust, not formula |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I had enough faith, God would heal me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I believe; help my unbelief. Heal as You see fit, and give me grace in the meantime. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*